

Household Linen Sewing as a Home-Based Livelihood: Linking Practical Skills, Creativity, and Family Income

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ABSTRACT

This conceptual article examines household linen sewing as a practical home-based livelihood pathway for Grade 6 learners and families. Drawing from Buyuccan's module on sewing creative and marketable household linens, the discussion connects basic sewing competence with resourcefulness, product quality, household utility, and income augmentation. The source material frames sewing not only as a hobby but also as productive work that requires tools, materials, appropriate attitudes, and safety consciousness. It further identifies table runners and curtains as examples of household linens that may be produced for domestic use or sale. Building on these ideas, the article argues that elementary Home Economics can introduce livelihood thinking without reducing learning to commercial activity. The educational value lies in helping learners see how creativity, accuracy, cleanliness, persistence, and responsible use of resources can be converted into useful products. The article concludes that sewing projects become especially meaningful when learners are guided to connect craftsmanship with family needs, simple

costing awareness, product presentation, and ethical enterprise.

Keywords: *household linens, sewing, livelihood education, family income, creativity, Grade 6 Home Economics*

INTRODUCTION

Sewing is one of the most accessible productive skills that can be taught within Home Economics because it links household needs, manual competence, creativity, and possible income generation. In the source module, sewing is presented as an activity that may be pursued either as a hobby or as a source of family income. This framing is important because it gives learners a practical reason for mastering the skill. The act of sewing becomes more than the production of an object; it becomes an exercise in planning, measurement, care, discipline, and the transformation of materials into something useful.

Household linens are described in the module as cloth items used in the home, including table runners, tablecloths, curtains, and table napkins. These articles are both functional and aesthetic. They serve household purposes while also contributing to the appearance of a living space. Because they are routinely used, repaired, replaced, and redesigned, household linens offer a realistic entry point for learners to understand the relationship between practical skills and livelihood opportunities.

Sewing as Productive Household Work

The module emphasizes that making household linens can save money because families do not always need to purchase ready-made items. This savings dimension is already a form of economic value. A family that can produce simple linens for its own use reduces household expenditure while building a skill base that may later support small-scale selling. In this sense, livelihood education begins with the recognition that productive ability has both consumption and income effects.

When sewing competence improves, the learner can move from merely following steps to exercising judgment over fabric choice, color combinations, decorative treatment, dimensions, and finishing. The module repeatedly associates attractiveness with neatness, proper sewing, and the use of decorative or colored threads.

These qualities matter in a market setting because a product is judged not only by whether it functions, but also by whether it appears carefully made and appropriate for the customer's intended use.

Creativity and Marketability

Marketability in the context of basic sewing does not require sophisticated business systems. At an introductory level, a marketable household linen is one that is useful, attractive, durable enough for its purpose, and produced with acceptable workmanship. Creativity strengthens marketability because it allows a simple item to be differentiated through color, pattern, finishing, proportion, and presentation.

The source module explicitly states that sewing can develop creativity and that learners may create quality products that can be sold. This suggests a progression:

learners first acquire fundamental skills, then apply those skills to create useful household products, and finally recognize that quality output may have exchange value. Such a progression is developmentally appropriate because the entrepreneurial idea grows from competence rather than from sales alone.

Educational and Family Implications

At the school level, sewing projects can cultivate responsibility for materials, accuracy in measurement, patience in completing steps, and pride in a finished product. At the family level, the same project can encourage learners to observe actual household needs. A table runner may be designed for a specific table; a curtain may be measured for a real window; fabric choices may be influenced by available resources. These authentic conditions make learning concrete.

For families considering small livelihood activities, learners should also be introduced to simple questions that extend the source module without departing from its intent: How much fabric and thread are needed? Which design is suitable for the intended user? How much time is required? Is the finished product neat enough to sell? What price would reasonably cover materials and effort? Even when precise costing is not yet part of the lesson, asking these questions helps connect craftsmanship with economic thinking.

CONCLUSION

Household linen sewing provides a clear example of how Home Economics can combine life skills and livelihood orientation. Buyuccan's module establishes the essential foundation: appropriate tools and materials, creativity,

safety, accurate procedures, and the possibility of selling quality output to augment family income. When these elements are taught as a connected process, learners begin to understand that useful knowledge can create both household value and economic opportunity. The strongest livelihood lesson is therefore not simply to sell a sewn item, but to learn how disciplined work, creativity, and quality can turn an ordinary material into a useful and potentially marketable product.

REFERENCE

Buyuccan, N. J. (2021). TLE home economics 6: Sewing creative and marketable household linens (1st ed.). Shirley Publishing House.